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promise on how they live.

The new senior-living home is not a dingy apartment. It's a spacious residence with landscaped grounds and hotel-style service. Swimming pools, gyms, libraries, salons, restaurants, miniature golf, walking tracks, and wellness studios are par for the course. But all this comes with step-free entrances, anti-skid flooring, wide corridors, emergency systems, and trained medical staff.

For developers, the proposition is as much about hospitality as housing. Residents are buying more than square footage. They are paying for convenience, social life, preventive health care, and the comfort of knowing that help is available.

At Better Life Homes, a one-bedroom apartment of about

1,200 sq. ft. costs ₹11,400 a night, including taxes and meals, while a 1,600-sq-ft two-bedroom apartment costs ₹23,300. The homes are not offered for sale.

"We get a lot of enquiries for sale as in India the mentality is still of building an asset and leaving an inheritance, but we want to change that," says Bijit.

Senior-living developments generally follow two models. In the lease or rental model, residents pay to live in a fully-serviced community without purchasing the property. This suits people seeking flexibility or preferring to divide their time between cities. The ownership model allows buyers to purchase a residence outright.

Rajeev Suri, 70, prefers the flexibility of leasing. He and his wife use Better Life Homes to escape Delhi,

enjoy the mountain air and spend time with like-minded people.

"I'm involved in various projects and that is still keeping me in Delhi, but when the opportunity arrives, I would like to move to Kasauli for a longer period of time," he says.

For many residents, however, the move is permanent. Menaka Singh, 72, relocated to Antara Senior Living in Dehradun after her husband's death. "I have a social circle here and have made friends," she says. "I don't have to bother with the daily headache of managing domestic staff and I am still close enough to Delhi to visit whenever I want."

Antara, one of the earliest premium players in the category, follows the ownership model. Its apartments range from 2,000-6,000 sq. ft. Its projects in Dehra-